

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 39

PENNSYLVANIA
WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Pennsylvania's family courts and child-welfare system.

163

PENNSYLVANIA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 271 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING TIME

DATA AS OF
OCTOBER 19, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
57 OF 67

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · PENNSYLVANIA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Pennsylvania. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Dr. Eric Bernstein

PSYCHOLOGICAL EVALUATOR · ALLEGHENY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

> *"He made a lot of assumptions that needed litigated, repeated the other party's false accusations and didn't listen to my children's attorney or the family counselor's research who both were working closely with my children, their dad and I. In our "high conflict" "contentious" case where I was told the court system is "not equipped" to handle our case. He made a report based on opinion and ex's sabotage. Didn't investigate but made a statement there was not abuse or alienation— which both were happening."*

> *"Complete misrepresentation of administered MMPI in order to benefit opposing counsel. Was not available for rebuttal, only offered written testimony during trial. Administered an MMPI and then completely misrepresented the results and subsequent conversations in a skewed fashion to benefit only opposing side. Has been accused of this several times over 15 years."*

> *"Said one thing in report and said another in court and was bias"*

Create Complaint Packet: https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/pa-dr-eric-bernstein/complaint-packet
Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

PENNSYLVANIA AT A GLANCE.

Across 163 Pennsylvania families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED
271
163 of 163 families reported child counts

MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN
$133,150
median across 66 families reporting 3+ categories

MEDIAN MONTHS LOST
18
of parenting time

WENT PRO SE
52.1%
85 of 163 who answered; 56 of 163 ran out of money

SUBMISSIONS	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN	COUNTIES REPRESENTED
163	1.7	163 of 163	57

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Pennsylvania families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

03 THE COST OF PENNSYLVANIA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	102	$23,000	$47,887	$4,884,440
Lost Wages	79	$15,000	$64,604	$5,103,678
Other Court Fees	51	$600	$3,200	$163,204
Therapy / Evaluations	68	$2,025	$5,186	$352,616
Reunification Services	51	$1,000	$3,869	$197,300
GAL Fees	46	$650	$2,602	$119,670
Asset Loss [1]	55	$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (66 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	$133,150	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least $1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median ($50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



04 WHO IS REPORTING · PENNSYLVANIA

Most families documenting in Pennsylvania are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed	81	50%
Not provided	25	15%
Case closed: within last 2 years	19	12%
Active case: progress being made	13	8%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago	12	7%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS	75	46%
Family Court Only	62	38%
CPS Only	13	8%
Unknown	13	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years	50	31%
3 – 5 years	29	18%
5 – 10 years	28	17%
6 months – 1 year	22	14%
Over 10 years	19	12%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access	42	26%
Visitation Only	37	23%
50/50 Joint	36	22%
Full Custody	17	10%
Children in Foster Care	13	8%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Bucks	9	7%
Allegheny	8	6%
Cumberland	6	5%
Westmoreland	6	5%
Chester	6	5%
Philadelphia	6	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)	52	32%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)	35	21%
High Conflict Divorce	16	10%
Other: (Short answer)	15	9%
Other	12	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — PENNSYLVANIA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Pennsylvania comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.

> *It has ripped my son away from me and his whole family. I am a healthcare professional and have no abuse or drug history. I have custody of my other 2 children. This judge has been stripping my rights using false accusations and twisting the narrative ruling biay w my ex who has [...]*
>
> — JACQUELYN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Took my babies with no due process after being sexually assaulted by partner altercation did not happen in front of kids. Investigation of find, no imminent danger presented.

— PENNSYLVANIA PARENT · KRYSTAL

MORE VOICES FROM PENNSYLVANIA

This system destroyed both children's childhood! It caused PTSD and Anxiety in the children. It ruined trusting adults and people in power positions meant to protect them (OCY, GAL) Mentally and physically ruined my health as I am currently on SSI due to being medically disabled [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed everything my self esteem confidence I have been so depressed and suicidal , I wrote a book , they are legally kidnapping children

— LEE

It has destroyed me completely and taken away my children's sense of security. They have three different agencies profiting off the removal of my kids and use my children as though they are pawns and that is unbearable. I cannot express the full extent of their actions because [...]

— KRISTI

Destroyed my mental health and caused trauma

— MICHELE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They have destroyed my kids and myself mentally and emotionally. My children are confused and scared.*
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

It took away my rights as a father, without even looking at everything. Now my kids are being alienated against me, they dont want to talk to me.

— MARK

Children lost years with rebar father due to multiple false reports of sexual abuse, trauma from unnecessary physical exams and interviews. Trauma from alienation. Children now believe they are survivors of sexual abuse that never happened. PTSD for father.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed me as a person as well as making bond with my kids very hard

— ROBERT

Took advantage of my kids' mom's trauma and manipulated them into destroying our family while giving them the illusion.They are winning

— SALVATORE

Father SA'd both daughters. System has caused loss of wages though missed work, allowed for continued abuse of daughters physically, sexually, and emotionally by Father. Perpetuated post-separation and financial abuse. Judge stopped previously ordered sexual trauma eval ordered [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Took my children from me. Broke my heart everyday by not having them with me.torn me and my children apart. The system has torn my children apart.

— ISABELLA

It has falsely accused, committed perjury over and over , all akowledged by judge , false police reports.

— NICHOLAS

CYS took my grandchildren unlawfully. We are all stressed and some Depressed and need help.

— MARILYN

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *You have ripped apart my family was zero regards. You guys hurt us so very badly after we been so hurt for so very long. You judges are very cruel*
>
> — BREANNE

Completely destroyed my family and continu s to manipulate the minds of my children

— JUSTIN

Destroyed a happy family. We were waiting for a date to adopt these kids.

— JULIA

Ripped is apart and did not take steps to reunify us as much as I met my goals they never intended to give my children back

— VICTORIA

Kept child in an abusive home where she has faced severe trauma, also kept me (mother) in trauma response living. Severe emotional, mental, and physical abuse the court will not let us escape from.

— MEGHAN

The family court system is broken and has violated my basic human rights. It protects the abuser. It's absolutely horrible.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court allowed my children to be sent to California without proper relocation procedures, disrupting their stability and my custodial rights. It forced our family into uncertainty without the protections the law is supposed to provide.

— SHANTEL

The juvenile system here in beaver county is completely corrupted! The lawyers and judges are taking advantage of the public by judges and local lawyers. I believe money is exchanging hands. When I asked a local attorney if this was all a joke and if things were settled behind [...]

— BRAD

Ripped away my 4 babies and handed them over to the child abuser/molester. Then blamed me for reacting inappropriately! Extreme fear for me and my side of the family. Could not say anything... or we would be placed in jail.

— LISA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *They have categorized my legal prescriptions as illegal drug use, removed my kids 4 times and allowed the father's to obtain sole everything with no evidence, hearing, or petition filed*
>
> — BRIANNE

They literally ripped my heart and soul right out of my body and left me with nothing inside but sheer emptiness .....

— STACY

They killed me. To take a mother's children is to take her life.

— KRISTINA

Destroyed us they have ruined my life and my kids I can only imagine how they feel we didn't deserve this they want my children to forget that our three month old baby existed like I guess nobody's allowed to bring her up to them. They took them to the funeral without our [...]

— SAMANTHA

The system let my abuser who traumatized my kids cause chaos and strife in my life and my kids' lives. I have videos of them sobbing because he tortured them emotionally. The court protected him for being an abuser and broke my bones in front of my kids and still made them go [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was a present father, who the corrupt system erased.

— NICHOLAS

The court system continues to enable a known abuser and allowing me to take the brunt of everything.

— LEE

I waited, I worked, I behaved, I paid, I was told "the kids will see the truth in the end". It's almost to the end and my children have been told a vicious lie about me that I may never undo.

— JASON

All of the actors in our case worked together, included our court appointed lawyers. They knew what they were doing. We did not. Our family was torn apart, ripped apart and fed to the wolves of this agency with no help from anyone who knew the law. Lawyers outside of the court [...]

— MELISSA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

> *This system has separated a healthy loving mother and her sons, ignored credible abuse, perpetuated abuse and allowed authority to be used as a weapon instead of protection. It has caused ongoing trauma, stripped the boys of their voices, and turned the pursuit of justice into a [...]*
>
> — LINDA

Has absolutely destroyed our peace and broken our family into pieces. Anyone who hears of this can't believe it happened to us!

— KAYLA

Broke it up, caused PTSD, ruined my kids future

— DOMINIQUE

Destroyed our family, our home. What was once safe and sacred now gone.

— SARAH

I have watched it destroy both me and my children's lives. It eve pushed one of my children to attempted suicide.

— CHRIS

This system stole very important years from me being with my children. They embarrassed and harrased them relentlessly in all areas of life. They KNOWINGLY put them in direct danger!! My children should have never been in the situations they were in. They saw so much violence [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has been manipulated by my ex husband who has been convicted of assault multiple times. I had a pfa from abuse. I can't afford an attorney due to my breast cancer medical bills. I have not seen my daughter consistently in over 2 years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has been a co-conspirator in my ex-husband's continued coercive control of me, financial abuse, psychological warfare and the emotional and physical abusive from neglect to my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My family has been harmed and traumatized by a Judge and a court system that is not educated or qualified to make decisions for families suffering from emotional, mental, financial, sexual, and economic abuse. Noone is obeying the code of ethics or the law in general, and there [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

110 Pennsylvania parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — PENNSYLVANIA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Pennsylvania families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

> It has ripped my son away from me and his whole family. I am a healthcare professional and have no abuse or drug history. I have custody of my other 2 children. This judge has been stripping my rights using false accusations and twisting the narrative ruling biay w my ex who has a record
>
> — JACQUELYN

> This system destroyed both children's childhood! It caused PTSD and Anxiety in the children. It ruined trusting adults and people in power positions meant to protect them (OCY, GAL) Mentally and physically ruined my health as I am currently on SSI due to being medically disabled with chronic pain. Narcissistic emotional abuse took a toll On my health as well as all of the physical, psychological, and emotional wellbeing of my children which all led to the last crt ordered counselors advising EMDR therapy for the trauma they experienced in their childhood. Once toxic father went no contact, children started their healing journey! It's all documented by crt ordered psychiatrist discharging daughter within 2 months and removing my daughter from her depression and anxiety meds!!!! Science doesn't lie!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Destroyed everything my self esteem confidence I have been so depressed and suicidal , I wrote a book , they are legally kidnapping children
>
> — LEE

> It has destroyed me completely and taken away my children's sense of security. They have three different agencies profiting off the removal of my kids and use my children as though they are pawns and that is unbearable. I cannot express the full extent of their actions because the pain is too great
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— SALVATORE

Father SA'd both daughters. System has caused loss of wages though missed work, allowed for continued abuse of daughters physically, sexually, and emotionally by Father. Perpetuated post-separation and financial abuse. Judge stopped previously ordered sexual trauma eval ordered by hearing officer after testimony from children's counselor and visit supervisor regarding concerning behaviors in Father's presence, Jude cut trial time in half and witness list by much more, judge did not do forensic interviews, CPS failed to investigate and Father refused cooperation with investigation, police failed to collect evidence of SA, judge asked for evidence ahead of trial, judge did not allow closing arguments, Judge hastened order due to staff needing to leave trial early for family events. Judges have held mother in contempt without valid evidence, refuse to hold Father in contempt when evidence is court-documented.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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The juvenile system here in beaver county is completely corrupted! The lawyers and judges are taking advantage of the public by judges and local lawyers. I believe money is exchanging hands. When I asked a local attorney if this was all a joke and if things were settled behind closed doors instead of the courtroom!?! She literally laughed and said “Brad you guys come to us with your problems”. They are using people custody issues to personally enrich themselves.

— BRAD

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— LISA

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>
> — SAMANTHA

> The system let my abuser who traumatized my kids cause chaos and strife in my life and my kids' lives. I have videos of them sobbing because he tortured them emotionally. The court protected him for being an abuser and broke my bones in front of my kids and still made them go with him.
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> I waited, I worked, I behaved, I paid, I was told "the kids will see the truth in the end". It's almost to the end and my children have been told a vicious lie about me that I may never undo.
>
> — JASON

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> All of the actors in our case worked together, included our court appointed lawyers. They knew what they were doing. We did not. Our family was torn apart, ripped apart and fed to the wolves of this agency with no help from anyone who knew the law. Lawyers outside of the court system wouldn't to fight with us because they refused to go against cps. As a family unit, and separately, we were falsely accused, beaten down, gaslit and condemned. But... We have survived and our family will one day be revived.
>
> — MELISSA

> This system has separated a healthy loving mother and her sons, ignored credible abuse, perpetuated abuse and allowed authority to be used as a weapon instead of protection. It has caused ongoing trauma, stripped the boys of their voices, and turned the pursuit of justice into a source of harm for our family.
>
> — LINDA

> Has absolutely destroyed our peace and broken our family into pieces. Anyone who hears of this can’t believe it happened to us!
>
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> Broke it up, caused PTSD, ruined my kids future
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> — SARAH

> I have watched it destroy both me and my children's lives. It eve pushed one of my children to attempted suicide.
>
> — CHRIS

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system stole very important years from me being with my children. They embarrassed and harrased them relentlessly in all areas of life. They KNOWINGLY put them in direct danger!! My children should have never been in the situations they were in. They saw so much violence and were abused not only by their father, but by the female he was with. The same system saved her kids by removing them and allowing her mother to have them. The father had an entire story made up to humiliate me and make me appear unstable. All out of malice and spite from him and revenue for the county.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has been manipulated by my ex husband who has been convicted of assault multiple times. I had a pfa from abuse. I can't afford an attorney due to my breast cancer medical bills. I have not seen my daughter consistently in over 2 years.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has been a co-conspirator in my ex-husband's continued coercive control of me, financial abuse, psychological warfare and the emotional and physical abusive from neglect to my children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My family has been harmed and traumatized by a Judge and a court system that is not educated or qualified to make decisions for families suffering from emotional, mental, financial, sexual, and economic abuse. Noone is obeying the code of ethics or the law in general, and there is no accountability for the abusive party, lawyers, or Judges.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Seperated my family, hurt my kids education and social development and put my kids back into the control of a drug dealer.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My goal to get my kids back and get our life back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> falsely accused my of something with zero evidance to support claims.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My son was one of the kids medically kidnapped at the hospital because he had a diagnosed that wasn't known at the time called AFfFrid . It an eating disorder mostly Autistic children have . It's textures anxiety anorexia and buulimia all in one and he was also beaten and starved by his stepmother and father . And then taken to New Jersey with out my knowledge after father ran off and gave my child to his mother to raise for money
>
> — MAUREEN

> I have lost years with my daughter, she took the beautiful life we had and destroyed it. She forces us to be in contact with the person who abuses people for his own benefit. There is no way out. She doesn't give us a choice. We're not parent vs parent. This is parent vs GRANDPARENT!
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Delaware County Family Court ripped my family apart, all in the name of protecting a mans parental rights, despite the long list of Domestic Violence accusations and a criminal record that included aggrevated assault. At no point was the children's well being taken into consideration. It deeply scared both my children and they are struggling to cope with life today.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has stolen time from me and my son; acknowledging that there is NO abuse or neglect; simply running me in circles; while two foster parents continually fail to get my son, the medical care that he needs and the courts allow their medical neglect.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Allowed ex husband to gain custody using false accusations against me
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The family court system has robbed me of 18 months with my son after I was falsely arrested and incarcerated for "kidnapping my own son for ransom" — charges that were completely fabricated and later dismissed after a full acquittal. While I was locked up, my son's mother, with the court's assistance, obtained sole custody through an ex parte emergency order built on lies, including the same perjured "man with a gun" story she had previously used and been disproven on. This system continues to drag out proceedings with no finality in sight, protecting her perjury while punishing me for trying to be a father. This is not incompetence — this is by design. The family court system is engineered to break families apart, separate children from fit parents, and weaken the foundation of this nation. Just as they have taken my son from me, this same broken system makes it easier for outsiders to seize our inheritance, our property, and our legacy. It is a machine that destroys families and undermines the strength of our country, one case at a time

— STEPHEN

Protect victims and advocate for survivors. My children are still suffering and I will never stop fighting for them.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely destroyed a father and sons relationships! Caused me to have mental and medical issues, and this gave my narcissistic ex time to further alienate my sons from me and court forcing me to pay max support because they took my custody away completely! It's a rigged game but I'm playing chess with them and won't stop !

— JEREMY

The system has helped my ex to continue to control and abuse me and my children's lives through ongoing financial abuse, malicious prosecution, and emotional distress.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destruction created and will never be ok. My daughters childhood ruined

— MELANIE

We were legally strapped into a 10 year battle after a caseworker false testimony and even when the transcripts revealed the truth, the court refused to correct the errors.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I did what I was told by the court and quickly got my kids back

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The immense damage being inflicted upon a child through injustice is EVIL.

— MICHELE

My daughter & I still have PTSD from this experience. I couldn't afford the lawyer who wanted to sue the school and CPS for civil rights violations. The damage is permanent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Torn my family apart and has damaged my poor son

— TAYLOR

Time is a thief and when you're robbed even of that thief, I don't even know how to explain it. I'm infuriated and disgusted.

— SAMANTHA

A crooked judge removed my parental rights and placed my son with his father who voluntarily abandoned him from the ages of 3-7 after a criminal investigation was opened on the father. The judge had police kick in my door and sent me to prison twice for trying to protect my son.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system took my son, my dignity, and my voice. They manipulated a narrative that was unfounded despite working with every agency possible for interventions for my son instead.

— AMBER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The corrupt family court system doesn't care about what's best for our children they only care about their profits . They ruined our loving family tore us apart without due process or evidence of any wrongdoing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has deprived us of joy and privacy for no reason except to further and foster my ex husband's narcissistic abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Family court is not only ruining present day families, it's ruining the mental health of the future generations. My children will spend the rest of their lives, healing from trauma that they never deserved and they had no choice in. They will spend the rest of their lives mourning the years they went without their mother that they can never get back. It's a crisis.

— EMILY

Family Court is a money making blood bath Colosseum. Most Judges do not actually care about the safety or wellbeing of children. They use our children's lives to make their pockets fatter and to feel powerful and in control. But that stops now. We are in the age of ACCOUNTABILITY for all systems. We won't stop until our children and all the future children are safe.

— CHRISTEN

I cant even talk about it. I attempted suicide 3 times and still consider trying again almost everyday.

— TAYLOR

the corruption of the cys system has done nothing short of traumatizing my daughter, myself, and my brother who lives with us. we have no other family anymore, all i want to do is teach my baby girl everything and just grow with her. almost 3 years of lost time that can never be replaced or made up for.

— ASHLYN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I have my son back. My son's father/his parents attorney was found guilty of multiple things and lost her license to practice. The grandmother tried to do this again. After I already had sole custody. He was ripped from me that time for approx 3 weeks. She lied to the police I was thrown in jail. She attempted to 302 me and I was released but arrested right after. Zero trace of those charges but the mug shot I have in my phone and the list. He is special needs. I have him now and the fear always remains

— HEIDI

The system tried to break me and has physically, mentally and emotionally hurt my children. I stood with my head held high and fought to help my children understand and work through the trauma that the system caused. As a mother that has been through it don't stop fighting for yourself and your children

— CHRISTINA

Instead of protecting families, this system deepened the trauma. We were left dealing with PTSD, resentment, anxiety, and a child who no longer trusts the people meant to help him.The trauma caused by parental alienation and abuse didn't end when the case did — it follows our family every single day through fear, anger, and heartbreak.The damage done to my son and our family cannot be undone.

— JENN, ELK COUNTY, PA

This system has done irreparable harm to my daughters and I by not protecting my girls and advocating for them over their abuser. The precious time we have lost together can never come back nor can the harm done ever be truly reversed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Stolen my son's childhood .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Absolute traumatic experience

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> This is going to be the second lawyer that I get rid of so far it is not doing anything to help us
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Made us spend a fortune on court by constantly being drug through for petty filings.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system gave my child to a self admitted child predator who is not her biological father.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Unlawfully tore my family apart.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Only listen to one side of the story
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Torn my family apart, devoted protective mother who loves her children more than life itself, 2 in kinship care and a newborn in foster care at only two days old. I've been fighting and doing everything asked of me and it's still not good enough! Judge is looking to ITPR. I'm lost, confused and hurt beyond belief and now trust no sort of government officials
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My kids have been robbed of time with a father who was with them everyday and an active loving father that they will never get back. My son has been robbed of his innocence and my children have been used as pawns in my exs sick games all while the courts have enabled her behavior. I grew up without my parents. I told myself I would never do that to my kids. And then people who I'm suppose to have faith in and trust to do right by my kids have now made that a reality.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> It has financially starved my family to the point that I am unable to afford to live in my own and provide things that I would be able to on my income. My oldest is resentful because all my money goes to defending myself against her sister's father and she has been called out of class by cps for false allegations. My mother has taken from retirement. We are constantly on edge because we do not know what false allegations will come up next.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> They took a man who had not seen his child long enough for it to be considered abandonment and gave him 50/50
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has destroyed my family as they have been pulled from their normal life into this endless hell just because of the maliciousness of the opposing party and all of their blind followers. There is no justice.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> It's stripped me as a father. I'm not even on the birth certificate she's has ruined me financially mentally and physically causing me to make mistakes at work that could potentially get me hurt or killed
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> My ex is using my baby boy as a pawn to get money out of me.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The system has traumatized my child in a manner she is forced to endure condoned alienation and parental interference with a "do better" from the court.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I want people to know that the courts are not fair. The judges are not fair. There should be cameras in the courtroom because the judges assigning with the other people‘s lawyers and the public should know what’s going on inside this courthouse with the family court how damaged they are how broken they are how they’re stealing our children away from us with no proper evidence. Our children are leaving good homes to go into rotten places like my grandchildren who are being strangled by the father‘s girlfriend and black eyes bad diaper rashes that are almost killing them and no one is doing anything in the four years that I have been dragged or caught

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has shattered an already broken; but still united, family. After losing my two-year-old we were stong enough to conquer any storm; now, our whole family is in a whirlwind; confused,lost and defeated amd shown zero mercy or regard to our pssibly irrepearable bond.

— AMBER

Family Division cancelled my 4 generational family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has made me move from my home and live in my car.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It tore us apart. It created a rift in the family dynamic and parental bond that will be forever scar my children and deprive them from the safety and comfort that they had before the system was involved.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

To not have the truth seen and all ignored has been torture to our grandchild and the whole family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

total destruction of the family bonds, heritage,total absorbtion of the familiy wealth PAST, PRESENT,AND FUTURE wealth too! theft of one's very own sustanance.

— ALLEN

The father of my children utilizes the system for revenge and to fracture my healthy relationship with my children. He's a wicked individual and he will be held accountable. □⚖️ □□

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took a happy thriving child and allowed a stranger with past abuse allegations and chronic alcohol problems to gain 50/50 custody all while turning this happy child into a angry child and distant kid I never met before.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have destroyed my relationship with my daughter. Many false allegations that no one investigated. Criminal case kept no possession of evidence. I'm disabled and the stress and PTSD was incredible to bare. Couldn't even get my medical needs from my house. House was destroyed the 4 years I was not permitted on the premises along with damaged and missing property.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is completely destroyed us. We have nothing left to give. We have given everything including things. We didn't have to just do what they wanted , to be their image of a perfect parent looks like all to be told that it didn't matter what we did it was never gonna be good enough.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has torn apart my family. I was my son's safe haven as a stay at home mom and his world is shattered by the courts decisions to keep him away and be so ignorant to whats in front of their faces

— LISA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

A CYS worker forced me to sign a safety plan, threatened that if I failed to sign my daughter would go in foster care. This was a first violation and she did not reveal my rights in the policy which I learned after the plan was signed and after I missed a hearing to appeal. She did not provide me with a copy of the document I signed at the time and this led to missing hearing

— MELANIE

My daughter's father has alienated our daughter from me, a pattern of behavior that has been going on for the past 13 years, and now I am now being called a child abuser and have a pfa filed against me, for our daughter simply because I filed for child support. I miss my baby. This is straight perjury and I will get justice for my baby and myself.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has given a criminal custody of my granddaughter, is forcing my daughter to deal daily with her abuser in order to have visitation with her daughter and the court keeps saying they do not have to reunify her with her daughter because she was given to the criminal father. The courts have still not given her son back to her, he is in foster care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family court, specifically Laura Valles and countless CYF workers have ruined my child's childhood making them grow up much faster to adapt to their father's reckless alcoholism and psychological/emotional abuse. Our child now needs homeschooled due to their complete lack of trust in adults at the age of 12. Father neglects the child and self-proclaimed themself to be a Disney dad at the hearing and then being given substantially MORE custody. Our child has no supervision and no one person in the system cares to address it.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has shown me that it is only there to protect itself. A child is now without a parent for maybe their entire childhood because one parent was trusted without question and the other was guilty until proven innocent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

> It took a beautiful, safe, loving family and turned us into an anxiety riddled broken mess who barely has the will to live. My daughter is cutting herself and I am barely hanging on. It has almost made me turn to substances but I can't and won't fail us.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> The family court has taken our peace and sense of safety. Everything I do must be scrutinized to avoid retaliation and unlawful loss of custody of my child. My child is neglected in the other home. I have lost faith in my fellow man and have no faith in marriage anymore. .
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> Been working 2 jobs to keep my roof over my head and the evaluator criticizes that on her report. They tried to bring me down but I am still standing and giving them a hard time to bury me.
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I moved to a different county with permission f the court, a year later I lost custody of my son the judge that allowed me to move said I had no business moving, accused of alienating my son from his father, accused of so much more, I even spent the weekend in the county jail for contempt that I didn't do! I'm not sure if there is enough room for everything! I can tell you we had the biggest custody in the county! I had no chance in hell all of his realitives worked in the court house! I would file it would disappear! I had proof I filed didn't matter! I lost all contact but a phone call once a week on Fridays
>
> — ANONYMOUS PARENT

> I haven't seen my 2 youngest sons in almost 2 years. I've missed out on birthdays, Christmas, Mother's Day, and so so much more. Their sister misses her brothers as well! I've been called names, talked about online, criticized, but I keep fighting and hoping for change! My oldest son just turned 18, and finally we are able to have somewhat of a relationship. It just doesn't make up for the time lost. I'm still not even sure why I lost primary custody anyways, and why nobody has been able to help me with our current custody order.
>
> — LINDA

110 full approved Pennsylvania comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Pennsylvania report comes from Pennsylvania respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Pennsylvania — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 163 Pennsylvania families reporting here are not the universe of Pennsylvania families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – October 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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